

Example of a Bad User Interface Design

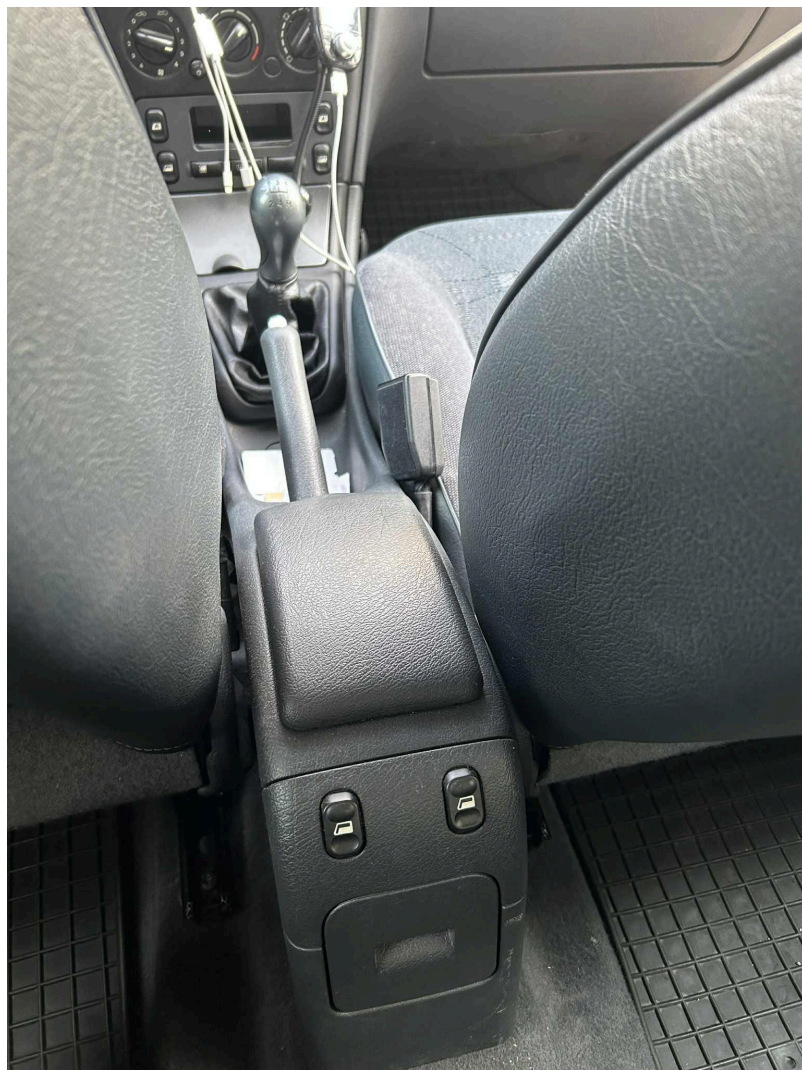
The Citroën Xsara's rear window control system allows passengers to open and close the back seat windows.

In this car model, the window controls for the rear seats are located in the center panel behind the handbrake. From my experience, almost no new users are able to find where the controls for the rear windows are located.

The placement of the controls violates basic usability principles such as visibility and ease of access.

This unusual placement was likely an attempt by the designers to experiment with a new interface concept and to differentiate the car from competitors.

Suggested Improvement: Follow the standard convention used in most cars — place the window controls near the door handles. This would make the interface more intuitive, easily discoverable, and accessible to all passengers.



Example of a Good User Interface Design

In the 2003 Mercedes Vito, the handbrake is still a manual system rather than the automatic electronic type found in newer vehicles. Because the Vito is a 9-seater, placing a traditional handbrake lever to the right of the driver would reduce space for the front passenger. To avoid this, Mercedes designed the handbrake as a dedicated pedal located on the far left side of the driver's footwell. This placement makes it impossible to confuse with any of the other pedals.

To engage the handbrake, the driver simply presses the pedal with their foot. To release it, the driver pulls a dedicated handle.

Advantages of this design: more cabin space, easier cabin movement, easy to find.

